



Green



NON-VASCULAR PLANTS

Non-vascular plants include mosses, worts, and a mainly freshwater group of green algae called Chlorophyta. They don't have flowers and they reproduce using spores. Without the specialized tissue of vascular plants, they do not generally grow tall.

Plants are divided into two groups according to how they absorb water and how they reproduce. Plants that take in water from the soil through their roots are called vascular plants. They have special cells that run the length of their stem and allow them to pull water up to the top of the plant.



Non-vascular plants have to absorb water through their leaves because they *don't have true roots or stems*. They need to live in damp places, otherwise they would DRY OUT too quickly.



Mosses

are low-growing, small-leaved plants. They have hardly any roots to anchor them and have to take in water through their leaves. The spores are carried in a capsule suspended above the plant by a stalk.



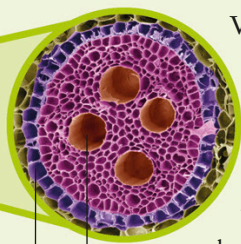
Worts

have a ribbon-like plant body called a thallus or are arranged as a series of overlapping, segmented leaves. They are usually less than 4 in (10 cm) long and bear their spores on stalks.



Inside a stem

Vascular plants have two sets of tubes running through their stems. The xylem transports water and minerals from the roots to the leaves and flowers. The phloem transports sugars made in the leaves to the rest of the plant. Plants use these essential nutrients to grow and reproduce.



Xylem
Phloem

Green algae

vary greatly in size from tiny single cells to large seaweeds. They grow wherever there is water—even on ice and snow. To reproduce, they spread their spores by air or water.

